centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

ACNE CARE

You (your child) have just received care for acne by a doctor at Centre UP. Here are some general principles to accompany the prescription and help maximize the effectiveness of care.

HOW TO TAKE PRESCRIBED ACNE MEDICATION?

- Bacteria residing on the skin can contribute to the development of acne.
- **Topical antibiotics** are often used to treat acne.
- Your doctor may prescribe oral **Doxycycline** (or another similar medication).
  Please note :
  - You can take this tablet with food, except dairy products.
  - Do not go to bed until one hour after taking the medicine.
  - This medicine may cause your skin to be sensitive to the sun; protect yourself from sun exposure.
  - It is important to take this medication regularly for it to be effective.
  - If you feel that your acne is not improving or that your condition is worsening after stopping the antibiotic, please consult your doctor again, as it is not recommended to take this medication for more than 6 months.

CAN I TOUCH ACNE (i.e. POP PIMPLES)?

- NO. Do not touch or manipulate acne.
- Avoid popping your pimples, as this can lead to further redness, scarring or dark spots.

CAN DIET HAVE AN EFFECT ON ACNE?

- YES. Avoid sugary foods and drinks. These lead your body to overproduce hormones that can worsen your acne.

SHOULD IT BE OF CONCERN IF THE TREATMENT DOES NOT PROVIDE A RESPONSE WITHIN THE FIRST WEEK?

- NO. Acne treatments can take 8 to 10 weeks before you see any improvement.
- At the start of treatment, your acne may temporarily worsen.

HOW TO REDUCE SKIN IRRITATION?

- Acne medications can cause skin dryness.
- Wait 30 minutes after washing your face before applying any topical treatment.
- If irritation occurs, apply a non-comedogenic moisturizer immediately after applying the topical treatment.
- You can also space out the treatment every 1 to 3 evenings until the irritation has resolved. If you have very sensitive skin, you may only be able to apply the medication every other night.

*The recommendations provided in this document are based on general knowledge and experience in the field. However, the educational material contained in this document is NOT a substitute for the clinical judgment necessary to address the diverse needs of patients.